LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH (GR 3–5) INTERMEDIATE: STORY, QUIZ & MUSIC STUDIO

Lesson 10: Notes and Melodies

Module 4 | 45 minutes | Sequences in music | Grades 3–5 · ages 8–10

Objective: Play notes and melodies with the music blocks, using note numbers, beats and loops for rhythms.

Success criteria

- I can play notes with note numbers.
- I can make a melody as a sequence.
- I can use a loop for a rhythm.

Key vocabulary

- **note**: A single musical sound with a pitch.
- **beat**: The steady pulse of music; a unit of time.
- **melody**: Notes played one after another to make a tune.
- **rhythm**: A pattern of long and short sounds.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Body percussion (5 min): clap a rhythm pattern; the class repeats it 4 times (a loop). Then change one beat.
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	Play a tune: learners follow the steps.
14 min	**Perform**	Code Lab: first melody, Match each note number to its name
9 min	**Probe**	Code Lab: rhythm loop, Count the notes, activity
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: Write the 3 blocks that play C then G, four times.

Unplugged warm-up

Body percussion (5 min): clap a rhythm pattern; the class repeats it 4 times (a loop). Then change one beat.

Teaching the idea

Music in Scratch is a sequence of note events with durations in beats; MIDI numbers map to pitches (60 = middle C). Loops express repetition in rhythm and melody. This reinforces sequence and loops through a different medium.

Analogy: A melody is a script for your ears: notes in order, with timing.

Live demo: Play the “Twinkle” opening (60 60 67 67 69 69 67) and ask learners to spot the repeated pairs.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Which number is middle C?	60.
How do you make a note longer?	More beats.
Where does your tune repeat?	Identify the pattern to loop.

Differentiation

Support
Provide the note number chart and a 4-note tune to copy.

Stretch
Compose an 8-bar tune with a repeating chorus (loop) and a different ending.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Bigger numbers mean louder	Bigger note numbers mean higher pitch.
Beats are seconds	Beats depend on tempo; here 1 beat ≈ 0.5 seconds.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write the 3 blocks that play C then G, four times.

Homework
Write the note numbers for a tune you know (or make one up).

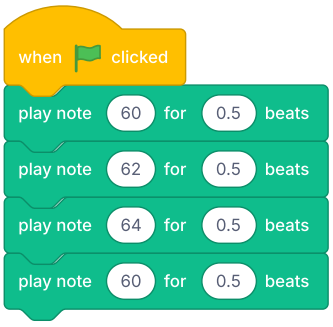
Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Code Lab: first melody (perform · code lab)

Goals checked: Plays 4 notes · Starts with the green flag

One solution:

Piano



2. Match each note number to its name (perform · matching)

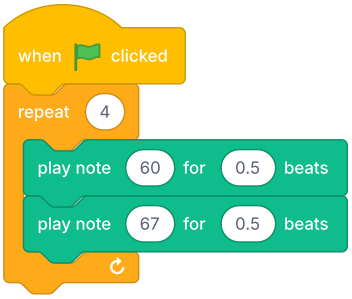
60 → C (middle C) · 62 → D · 64 → E · 67 → G

3. Code Lab: rhythm loop (probe · code lab)

Goals checked: Plays 8 notes · Uses a loop · Short code

One solution:

Piano



4. Count the notes (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: 7

5. Explain your thinking (probe · free response)

Look for: note, repeat, beat. **Example:** Happy Birthday starts with two short notes the same, then goes up. The first line repeats with a different ending, so I could use the same notes twice and change the last two.

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** note = A single musical sound with a pitch. · beat = The steady pulse of music; a unit of time. · melody = Notes played one after another to make a tune. · rhythm = A pattern of long and short sounds.
2. **Plan your code:** Goals: Plays 4 notes; Starts with the green flag.
3. **Match each note number to its name:** 60 → C (middle C) · 62 → D · 64 → E · 67 → G
4. **Plan your code:** Goals: Plays 8 notes; Uses a loop; Short code.
5. **Count the notes:** A — 2 notes × 3 repeats = 6, plus 1 more after the loop = 7.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.